

are times my stockpiling has bordered on hoarding. Deal shopping could have the potential of taking valuable time from something else in a person's life, like their husband, family, or other hobbies. I happened to share my hobby with my husband and children, but did they always enjoy it nearly as much as I did? Did the children have a choice, or were they unwilling participants in some grand social adventure that involved boxtops, labels, and hundreds of pieces of paper their mother coveted more than purses and jewelry?

Is it also true that couponing, particularly double couponing, devalues a brand, as Jill Cataldo contends in an October 2012 CPGMatters report? If so, what can happen when a consumer accumulates a large stockpile of free items?

I need look no further than my bathroom cabinet and reflect back on the “bandage incident” to know the truth of devaluation. Several years ago, one of my children, a child who shall remain nameless, appeared before me as I worked at my desk. She was plastered head to toe with bandages. Rather than gasp in dismay at the waste, I admired her creativity in finding something that had apparently entertained her and a sibling for a good hour while I worked on submitting rebates. This was back in the day of plentiful refunding, when I could spend a good hour or two in my office, fulfilling offers. At the time, I'd stockpiled an entire shelf of bandages in my bathroom cupboard, bandages that had been completely free with coupons. Seeing a plentiful supply of the product, my enterprising children had orchestrated a session of “doctor”—a session that involved a badly injured patient needing bandages to stem the flow of imaginary blood. *Because the*